



The Norm-Breaker

A quick, fun way to practice holding each other accountable

Role-play is the fastest way to make the norm-violation conversation feel normal instead of scary. People secretly get assigned to break a norm during a silly mock meeting, and everyone else practices kindly calling it in using the five moves. Because the topic is ridiculous and the “breaking” is obviously an act, the real skill gets rehearsed while everyone's laughing. Pairs with the “Holding Each Other Accountable” worksheet.

Time	About 25 minutes
Group size	Small groups of 4–5 (PLT or mixed)
Materials	Norm-Breaker cards (page 2, cut out ahead), sticky notes, the five-move worksheet, and a small prize

Run of show

1 Confessions of a Norm-Breaker

≈5 min

Everyone anonymously writes on a sticky the one norm they're most likely to break (“I check my phone,” “I interrupt when I'm excited”). Collect them in a bowl and read a handful aloud. It lands the whole point out loud: everyone slips — that's normal.

2 Mini-teach

≈3 min

Show the five moves from the worksheet and, as a staff, agree on one shared in-the-moment signal (e.g., “let's check our norms,” or a double tap on the table). No lecture.

3 The game

≈12 min

Each group runs a 4-minute mock PLT meeting on a silly topic. Before starting, 1–2 people per group secretly draw a Norm-Breaker card — no one else knows who has one. When someone notices a norm being broken, they use the signal, then practice a move + stem to call it in kindly.

4 Debrief + the Golden Redirect

≈5 min

Quick debrief: Who felt least awkward being called in? Which stem felt natural? Each group nominates its smoothest, kindest redirect, and an applause-o-meter crowns the staff “Golden Redirect” winner.

Silly meeting topics (pick one per group)

- Plan the school's first field trip to Mars.
- Design the impossible perfect school lunch.
- Choose a new mascot to rival the Tiger.
- Plan the staff talent show.

Two facilitator keys

- **Leaders go first — and laugh at yourselves** — If a leader happily plays the Idea Assassin and gets called in, everyone else relaxes.
- **Name the point at the end** — It felt fine because the call-in was about the behavior, kind, and in the moment — the exact guardrails on the worksheet.

Lower-energy alternative — “Cringe or Coach”

For staff who'd rather not perform: hand out pairs of responses to the same violation (one accusatory and public, one using a stem). Tables sort each pair into “cringe” vs. “coach,” then rewrite one cringe line into a coach line. Quieter, same learning.

Norm-Breaker cards

Print and cut out. Deal 1–2 per group, face down. Players keep their role secret and (gently, briefly) play it up during the mock meeting.



The Phantom Texter

Check your phone every 20 seconds like you're awaiting urgent news.



The Interrupter

Never let anyone finish a sentence.



The Topic Tourist

Steer every comment back to your weekend, lunch, or a TV show.



The Idea Assassin

Shoot down every suggestion with “that'll never work.”



The Spotlight Hog

Take credit for every good idea and hog the airtime.



The Side-Barista

Start whispered side conversations with a neighbor.



The Ghost

You're physically there, arms crossed, contributing nothing.



Make Your Own

Invent a norm to (gently) break — keep it realistic.